Who will view this Dashboard?

- Senior Managers & Business Leaders
- Data Analysts / Business Analysts

→ who need unified data visibility

What problem does this dashboard solve?

Unifies fragmented data sources to answer 3 critical business questions.

- What is the current overall business performance?
- Which markets should we expand?
- Which products/SKUs should be optimized or eliminated?

When & Where will stakeholders view this dashboard?

When:

- Strategic planning & quarterly reviews
- Investment / expansion decision-making

Where:

- Leadership meetings
- Business performance reviews

Why do stakeholders need this dashboard?

- Move from static reporting → actionable insights
- Understand why: Revenue ↑ +51.5% but Margin only 11.61%
- Enable faster, data-driven strategic decisions

How have stakeholders tried to solve this?

- Analyzing 50K+ transaction records manually
- Using disconnected reports with no dimensional linkage

Stage 1: Empathize

5W1H Framework for Business Dashboard

Stage 1: Empathize

Empathy Map

Understanding Stakeholder Insights & Pain Points

What does the stakeholder think and feel?

- Thinks about global business performance and the constant pressure to grow continuously while margins remain flat (11.61%).
- Fears missing opportunities in high-potential markets like EMEA or failing to invest in the right products.
- Feels frustrated waiting for manual reports and lacks trust in unsynced data from various global regions.

What does the stakeholder see?

- Scattered reports in many Excel files (over 51,000 records) from different global teams, each with its own format.
- Significant revenue growth ($12.64M, +51.5% YoY) but a slight decline in profit margin (down 0.23 pp in 2014).
- Data inconsistency that makes it difficult to compare market performance quickly

What does the stakeholder say and do?

- "I need a global revenue overview on just one page to understand the company's health at a glance".
- "Tell me which products drive our profit and which ones erode it".
- Proactively looks for BI tools like Power BI to check data independently without waiting for analysts

What are the biggest problems and challenges?

- **Flat Profitability**: Revenue increased significantly, but profit margins remained flat, indicating a "growth-at-all-costs" pattern rather than efficiency.
- **Profit Eroders**: Specific sub-categories like Tables are causing **a net loss of $64,083** globally.
- **Operational Risks**: Certain SKUs have high return rates (overall rate of 4.68%) which materially dilute margins.
- **Weak Acquisition**: New customer acquisition is structurally low (only 0.99% of revenue in 2014)

What are the opportunities and benefits?

- **High-Margin Blueprint:** Replicate Canada's **26.62%** profit margin model—achieved by focusing on high-margin Technology and Office Supplies—in other regions.
- **Targeted Expansion:** Identify EMEA (+47.42% YoY) and Africa (+23.56% YoY) as the fastest-growing markets for prioritized investment.
- **Portfolio Optimization**: Focus on "Star" categories like Technology (13.99% margin) while restructuring or discontinuing loss-making furniture SKUs.
- **Strategic Efficiency:** Move from high-level reporting to actionable, strategy-focused insights to achieve a target profit margin above 15%

Design Thinking

Stage 2: Define

Stakeholder Journey Framework

STEP 1

Assessing Current Performance & Strategic Planning

Starting from the company's actual business situation—where total revenue reached $12.64M but the profit margin remained flat at 11.61%—the BOD and senior managers want to understand if this scale-driven growth is sustainable. They plan to move from a "growth-at-all-costs" approach to performance-driven growth, identifying where operational improvements are needed to eventually reach a >15% profit margin.

STEP 2

Data Insights Request & Dashboard Development

To get the needed insights from over 51,000 global transaction records, stakeholders reach out to Data Analysts to build a Power BI dashboard. This dashboard must clearly visualize the three critical pillars: overall business health, market expansion priorities (focusing on high-growth regions like EMEA and Africa), and product profitability (identifying both profit drivers and eroders).

STEP 3

Strategic Brainstorming & Decision Making

After receiving the dashboard, stakeholders hold strategic meetings to brainstorm and finalize the business path forward. Based on the data, they decide to prioritize expansion in EMEA (+47.42% growth) by replicating the high-margin model of Canada (26.62% margin). Simultaneously, they finalize plans to restructure "Margin Eroders," such as the Tables sub-category, which caused a global net loss of $64,083

STEP 4

Implementation & Continuous Monitoring

The expansion plan is launched in EMEA and Africa, focusing on high-margin categories like Technology (13.99% margin). Sales and return data (currently at a 4.68% return rate) are regularly updated in the dashboard to monitor the effectiveness of the new product mix and to ensure that repeat customer loyalty—which currently drives 99.01% of total revenue—remains strong while expanding into new customer segments.

Stage 2: Define POV & Northstar Metrics

1. Northstar Metrics Selection

NORTHSTAR 1: Net Profit Margin (%)

What VALUE you want to measure?
Operational efficiency and true bottom-line profitability.
WHEN the value DELIVERY SUCCESS?
When the margin meets or exceeds strategic targets (currently 11.61%, with a goal to reach >15%).
WHY do you choose this metric?
To shift from "growth-at-all-costs" to performance-driven growth. High revenue matters little if costs erode all gains, as seen with Tables causing a $64,083 loss.

NORTHSTAR 1: Total Revenue ($)

What VALUE you want to measure?
Market scale, customer adoption, and top-line growth.
WHEN the value DELIVERY SUCCESS?
When YoY growth targets are achieved (current revenue is $12.64M, up 51.5% YoY).

WHY do you choose this metric?
Directly aligns with the goal of Market Expansion. It represents cash inflow and proves that markets like EMEA (+47.42% YoY) are accepting the company's products.

2. Dimension Data Group

- Group 1: Location – Market (APAC, EMEA, etc.), Region, Country, and City.
- Group 2: Product – Category (Technology, etc.), Sub-Category, and SKU.
- Group 3: Time – Year, Quarter, Month, and Day to track trends from 2011–2014.
- Group 4: Operational/People – Salesperson (e.g., Anna Andreadi) and Return status

3. Strategic Views & Northstar Formulas

View	Description	Why?	Northstar Formula Breakdown
View 1	Overall Performance	Assess overall health to understand the global success level of the company	Profit: Total profit performance by year/quarter = SUM(Profit). Revenue: Total revenue growth = SUM(Sales) YoY
View 2	Market Analysis	Identify high-potential markets and regions for expansion	Profit: Market Profit Margin = (SUM(Profit) / SUM(Sales)) per Market (e.g., Canada at 26.62%). Revenue: Revenue by Market = SUM(Sales) grouped by Region/Country.
View 3	Product Analysis	Determine strategic products and evaluate strong vs. weak performers	Profit: Profit per Category/SKU = SUM(Profit) to find "Stars" (Technology) vs "Eroders" (Tables). Revenue: Revenue share by Category = SUM(Sales) across categories
View 4	Sales/Operational Performance	Evaluate salesperson contribution and operational risks like returns	Quality: Return Rate = (Orders Returned / Total Orders) * 100 (currently 4.68%). People: Individual Sales Performance = SUM(Sales) per Person

Stage 3: Ideate – Brainstorming

	Metric 1	Metric 2	Metric3	Metric 4	Metric 5	Metric 6
Scorecard	Total Profit ($1.5M)	Total Revenue ($12.64M)	Profit Margin (11.61%)	Revenue Growth (+51.5% YoY)	Return Rate (4.68%)	Total Orders (25,000)

Idea Name	Layer 0 Dimension (Total Indicators)	Layer 1 Dimension (1D Breakdown)	Layer 2 Dimension (2D Breakdown)
View 1: Overall Performance	Total Profit, Revenue, Margin, and YoY Growth	By Time: Yearly and Quarterly trends (2011–2014)	Time + Region: To see which regions drive annual peaks
View 2: Market Analysis	Revenue and Profit by Market/Region	By Market: Comparing Canada (26.62% margin) vs. EMEA (59.8% growth)	Market + Product Category: To see what Canada sells vs. EMEA
View 3: Product Analysis	Profit per Category and Sub-category	By Sub-Category: Identifying "Stars" (Copiers) vs. "Eroders" (Tables)	Category + Region: Pinpointing where Furniture causes the most loss (e.g., US Central)
View 4: Sales & Operations	Salesperson contribution and Return Rate	By Salesperson: Anna Andreadi ($2.9M in EU)	Region + Salesperson: To evaluate regional team effectiveness

Stage 3: Ideate - Structure Idea

Idea Name	Very Important Information	Important Information	Detailed Information
View 1: Overall Performance	**Trend Charts:** Revenue and Profit growth from 2011 to 2014	**Margin Analysis:** Highlighting the 11.95% peak in 2013 vs. 2014 adjustment	Breakdown by Customer Segment to see who performs best (Consumer vs. Corporate)
View 2: Market Analysis	Profitability Map: Highlighting Canada's record 26.62% margin	Growth Potential: Visualizing EMEA and Africa's >50% YoY growth	Country-level details: Identifying best-selling Technology items in high-growth regions
View 3: Product Analysis	**Pareto Analysis:** Copiers (17.13% margin) as the primary profit engine	Loss Detection: Tables category dragging Furniture margin down to 6.94%	SKU-level losses: Identifying specific items like Chromcraft Wood Tables (losses >$1,800/order)
View 4: Sales & Operations	**Top Performers:** Anna Andreadi's $2.9M contribution	Risk Monitoring: Return rate by Category (Printers/Advanced Equipment)	Loyalty Data: 99.01% revenue coming from returning buyers like Justin Ritter